

ANSWER KEY

Handling Difficult People — BSIS Elective Course

Instructor Copy — Retain Securely — Do Not Leave Unattended

16 Questions | Pass: 100% | BPC §7583.6(b)

QUICK REFERENCE — ALL ANSWERS

16 Q | Pass: 100%

Q1	B	Q2	B	Q3	B	Q4	B	Q5	D
Q6	C	Q7	B	Q8	B	Q9	C	Q10	C
Q11	A	Q12	C	Q13	C	Q14	B	Q15	C
Q16	D								

1

Communication Strategies

BSIS Training Manual

The most effective opening strategy when approaching a person who is behaving in a difficult or uncooperative manner is to:

- A. Immediately establish authority by stating the consequences of continued non-compliance
- C. State the post rule or policy that the person is violating, clearly and firmly

- ✓ B. Lead with empathy — acknowledge the situation before giving directions
- D. Step back and allow the person to resolve their own situation independently

B

2

Communication Strategies

BSIS Training Manual

Using 'I' statements in a difficult interaction — such as 'I need you to lower your voice' — is preferable because:

- A. 'I' statements are more legally defensible in incident documentation
- C. 'I' statements are always perceived as more authoritative than 'You' statements

- ✓ B. 'I' statements express personal responsibility without creating an adversarial framing
- D. 'I' statements are required by BSIS protocol for all verbal contacts

B

3

Communication Strategies

BSIS Training Manual

A guard working a difficult interaction allows the person to speak for a minute before responding. This technique is known as:

- A. Passive disengagement — withdrawing from the conflict to reduce tension
- C. Tactical silence — a use-of-force de-escalation tool requiring supervisor authorization

- ✓ B. Controlled venting — allowing brief emotional expression reduces hostility
- D. Permissive engagement — allowing the subject to control the interaction

B

4

Communication Strategies

BSIS Training Manual

When a difficult person's underlying need — rather than their stated demand — is identified and addressed, the conflict:

- A. Typically intensifies because addressing needs is perceived as weakness
- ✓ B. Often de-escalates, as the person feels heard and their core concerns have been recognized
- C. Becomes a legal matter that requires supervisor escalation
- D. Remains unchanged — underlying needs are not a security guard's concern

B

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Conflict Management

BSIS Training Manual

The earliest stage of conflict escalation — and the stage where intervention is most effective — is:

- A. Manifest conflict — when parties openly engage in the dispute
- B. Felt conflict — when emotions have begun to heighten
- C. Perceived conflict — when parties believe conflict exists but it has not erupted
- ✓ D. Potential conflict — when tension is present but conflict has not developed

D

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Conflict Management

BSIS Training Manual

Which statement best reflects effective constructive speaking during a conflict interaction?

- A. 'You always cause problems at this location — this is not the first time.'
- B. 'If you don't stop right now, I will be forced to take immediate action against you.'
- ✓ C. 'I understand this is frustrating. Here is what I can do to help resolve this.'
- D. 'I am not going to discuss this further until you calm yourself down completely.'

C

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Conflict Management

BSIS Training Manual

Following through on stated consequences is critical in conflict management because:

- A. It satisfies BSIS documentation requirements for conflict interactions
- C. It creates a clear legal record that the guard provided fair warning before taking action

- ✓ **B. Empty threats permanently destroy the guard's credibility and make future escalations more likely**
- D. Following through is not always necessary — situational judgment and flexibility

B

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Valuing Diversity

BPC §7583.6

A security guard encounters a person who is speaking loudly in what appears to be an emotional cultural expression that is normal in their background. The guard should:

- A. Treat the loud speech as an immediate threat indicator and prepare for escalation
- C. Apply the same threat response that would be used for any other loud verbal confrontation

- ✓ **B. Recognize that loudness alone — without threatening content — indicates hostility or danger**
- D. Contact law enforcement immediately — loud verbal behavior is a safety concern

B

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Valuing Diversity

BPC §7583.6

When a language barrier creates difficulty during a conflict interaction, the recommended approach is to:

- A. Speak more loudly and repeat commands with greater force — volume improves comprehension
- ✓ **C. Slow down, use simpler language, and seek an interpreter or translation tool if available**

- B. Immediately call law enforcement — language barriers make secure contact unsafe
- D. Assume non-cooperation and document the interaction as a refusal to comply

C

10

Valuing Diversity

BPC §7583.6

Offering realistic choices to a difficult person during a conflict interaction is effective because:

- A. It eliminates the guard's liability for any outcome the person chooses
- ✓ C. Providing choices restores the person's sense of control and reduces the psychological need to resist
- B. Choices are a BSIS-mandated conflict resolution protocol for all difficult contacts
- D. Choices make the interaction proceed faster, which reduces the risk of escalation

C

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Negotiation

BSIS Training Manual

When a guard finds common ground with a difficult person — such as 'We both want this to be resolved calmly' — this technique is known as:

- ✓ A. Collaborative framing — reorienting from adversarial to cooperative
- C. Operational capitulation — surrendering ground to achieve compliance
- B. Tactical deception — a legally questionable technique in California
- D. Position bargaining — exchanging concessions to reach a mutually acceptable outcome

A

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Negotiation

BSIS Training Manual

A guard is negotiating with a difficult person who demands an exception to a clearly stated post rule. The guard's response should be:

- A. Grant the exception to resolve the conflict and restore peace at the post
- ✓ C. Explain that the post rule cannot be negotiated — and offer to escalate to a supervisor who can assist
- B. Make the exception if the person seems genuinely reasonable and comply
- D. Threaten consequences and repeat the rule until the person complies

C

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Verbal Diffusion

BSIS Training Manual

When a guard deliberately lowers their own voice in response to an agitated person speaking loudly, the intended effect is:

- A. To signal to the person that the guard is also becoming agitated
- ✓ **C. To model calm behavior — people often unconsciously mirror the tone and volume of those they are speaking with**
- B. To demonstrate to bystanders that the guard is maintaining professional control
- D. To reduce the chance of a third party overhearing the exchange and intervening

C

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Verbal Diffusion

BSIS Training Manual

Naming the emotion during a difficult interaction — such as 'It sounds like you are really frustrated right now' — is effective because:

- A. It shifts legal responsibility for the interaction to the subject
- C. It classifies the interaction as an emotional crisis, which changes the applicable BSIS protocol
- ✓ **B. It demonstrates that the guard is taking the person seriously, which reduces perceived threat and defensiveness**
- D. It creates a formal record that the subject acknowledged the emotional statement

B

15

Review

BPC §7583.6

A guard observes that verbal de-escalation attempts are no longer reducing tension with a difficult subject — the subject is becoming more agitated. The appropriate next step is:

- A. Increase the intensity and firmness of verbal commands until compliance is achieved
- ✓ **C. Create distance, request backup, and allow the situation to stabilize before re-engaging**
- B. Immediately apply physical restraint before the situation escalates
- D. Continue the same de-escalation approach — consistency eventually produces compliance

C

16

Review

PPO License | BPC §7583.6

MACCESS INC.'s California Private Patrol Operator license number — which must appear on all BSIS Certificates of Completion — is:

A. #112233

B. #100001

C. #133445

✓ **D. #122729**

D

SCORING GUIDE & INSTRUCTOR NOTES

Passing Score

100% — all 16 questions correct required per BPC §7583.6(b)

Failed Assessment

Full retake required. Student must review all course modules before retaking.

Certificate

Issue Certificate of Completion ONLY upon 100% score. Sign, date, and retain a copy.

Record Retention

Retain each student's assessment record for duration of employment. Available to BSIS on request per Title 16 CCR §643(b).

Confidentiality

This answer key is for MACCESS INC. instructor use only. Never share with students before, during, or after assessment.

Live Scan

Live Scan integration is pending equipment acquisition. When active, completed LS records will be stored alongside training records.